



THE REPUBLIC OF KENYA

LAWS OF KENYA

THE ADVOCATES ACT

CAP. 16

Revised and published by the National Council for Law Reporting
with the authority of the Attorney-General as gazetted by the Government Printer

www.kenyalaw.org

Kenya

Advocates Act

Cap. 16

Legislation as at 26 April 2024

By [Kenya Law](#) and [Laws.Africa](#). Share widely and freely.

www.kenyalaw.org | info@kenyalaw.org

FRBR URI: /akn/ke/act/1989/18/eng@2024-04-26

There is no copyright on the legislative content of this document.

This PDF copy is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial ShareAlike 4.0 License ([CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)). This license enables reusers to distribute, remix, adapt, and build upon the material in any medium or format for noncommercial purposes only, and only so long as attribution is given to the creator. If you remix, adapt, or build upon the material, you must license the modified material under identical terms. CC BY-NC-SA includes the following elements:

- BY: credit must be given to the creator.
- NC: Only noncommercial uses of the work are permitted.
- SA: Adaptations must be shared under the same terms.

Share widely and freely.

Advocates Act (Cap. 16)

Contents

Part I – PRELIMINARY	1
1 Short title	1
2. Interpretation	1
Part II – THE COUNCIL OF LEGAL EDUCATION	2
3. [Repealed by Act No. 12 of 1995, s. 21.]	2
4. [Repealed by Act No. 12 of 1995, s. 21.]	2
5. [Repealed by Act No. 12 of 1995, s. 21.]	2
6. [Repealed by Act No. 12 of 1995, s. 21.]	2
7. [Repealed by Act No. 12 of 1995, s. 21.]	2
8. [Repealed by Act No. 12 of 1995, s. 21.]	2
Part III – PROVISIONS RELATING TO THE RIGHT TO PRACTISE AS AN ADVOCATE	2
9. Qualifications for practising as an advocate	2
10. Certain officers entitled to act as advocates	3
11. Foreign advocates	3
Part IV – ADMISSION AS ADVOCATE	4
12. Qualification for admission as advocate	4
13. Professional and academic qualifications	4
14. Attorney-General and the Director of Public Prosecutions may take pupils	5
15. Admission as an advocate	5
16. Custody of Roll	5
Part V – SENIOR COUNSEL	5
17. Senior Counsel	5
18. Roll of Senior Counsel	6
19. Application of Part XI	6
Part VI – PRECEDENCE	6
20. Precedence	6
Part VII – PRACTISING CERTIFICATE	6
21. Registrar to issue practising certificates	6
22. Application for and issue of practising certificate	7
23. Issue of practising certificate to confer membership of Society	7
24. Date and validity of practising certificate	7
25. Discretion of Registrar to issue practising certificate in special cases	8
26. Appeals in connection with issue of practising certificate	9
27. Suspension of practising certificate in certain circumstances	9

28. Duration of suspension of practising certificate	9
29. Publication of suspension or termination of suspension of practising certificate in certain cases	10
30. Evidence as to holding of practising certificate	10
30A. [Repealed by Act No. 9 of 2000, s. 60.]	10
30B. [Repealed by Act No. 9 of 2000, s. 61.]	11
30C. [Repealed by Act No. 9 of 2000, s. 62.]	11
Part VIII – PROVISIONS WITH RESPECT TO UNQUALIFIED PERSONS ACTING AS ADVOCATES AND OFFENCES BY ADVOCATES	11
31. Unqualified person not to act as advocate	11
32. [Repealed by Act No. 27 of 2012, s. 50.]	11
32A. Employment as in-house Advocate	11
32B. Standards of work and remuneration	11
33. Penalty for pretending to be advocate	12
34. Unqualified person not to prepare certain documents or instruments	12
34A. Additional endorsements	12
34B. Validity of legal documents	13
35. Instruments to be endorsed with name and address of drawer	13
36. Undercutting	13
37. Sharing profits	13
38. Touts	13
39. Advocate not to act as agent for unqualified person	14
40. No costs recoverable where unqualified person acts as advocate	14
41. Employment by advocate of persons struck-off the Roll or suspended	14
42. Penalty for failure to disclose fact of having been struck-off, etc.	14
43. Offences by bodies corporate	14
Part IX – REMUNERATION OF ADVOCATES	15
44. Chief Justice may make orders prescribing remuneration	15
45. Agreements with respect to remuneration	15
46. Invalid agreements	16
47. Power of court to order advocate to deliver his bill and to deliver up deed	17
48. Action for recovery of costs	17
49. Procedure in action where quantum of costs is challenged by defence	17
50. Taxation on application of third parties, beneficiaries under trust, etc.	18
51. General provisions as to taxation	18
52. Charging orders	18

Part X – COMPLAINTS COMMISSION	19
53. Establishment of Complaints Commission	19
53A. Remuneration of Commissioner	20
54. Secretary and staff of Commission and rules relating thereto	20
Part XI – DISCIPLINE	21
55. Advocates to be officers of Court	21
56. Savings of disciplinary powers of Court	21
57. Establishment of Disciplinary Tribunal	21
58. Proceedings of Tribunal	22
58A. Establishment of Regional Disciplinary Committees	22
59. Application for removal of name from the Roll	23
60. Complaints against advocates	23
60A. Hearing of complaints	24
61. Reports by Tribunal and action thereon	26
62. Appeal against order of Tribunal	26
63. Registrar to furnish copy of the report and record	26
64. Powers of Court	26
65. Powers of Court under section 64 to be exercised by two judges	27
66. Registrar to draw up orders	27
67. Right of appeal to Court of Appeal	27
68. Orders to be noted on the Roll	27
69. Law Society to be informed of result of disciplinary proceedings and publicity of striking-off or suspension	27
70. Limitation of time for certain applications to strike names off the Roll	28
71. Restoration to Roll	28
72. Disciplinary powers as to clerks	28
73. Clerk's right of appeal	29
74. Offences and penalties with respect to employment of clerks against whom an order is in force	29
75. Order of Tribunal to be received in evidence	29
76. Authentication of rules and other documents	29
77. Penalties for failure to comply with order of Tribunal	29
78. Immunity for members of Tribunal	29
79. Right to legal representation	30
80. Betrayal of trust	30

Part XII – MISCELLANEOUS PROVISIONS	30
81. Power to make rules	30
82. Relief to banks	31
83. Saving of other laws	31
84. Application of certain fees, etc.	31
85. General penalty	31
86. Repeal and savings	31
FIRST SCHEDULE [s. 3]	32
SECOND SCHEDULE [s. 86]	32

ADVOCATES ACT

CAP. 16

Assented to on 13 December 1989

Commenced on 15 December 1989

Note: Section 32 — 1st January, 2000

[Amended by [Statute Law \(Repealed and Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 1990 \(Act No. 7 of 1990\)](#) on 22 June 1990]
[Amended by [Council of Legal Education Act \(Act No. 12 of 1995\)](#) on 27 December 1995]
[Amended by [Finance Act, 2000 \(Act No. 9 of 2000\)](#) on 1 January 2001]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2002 \(Act No. 2 of 2002\)](#) on 7 June 2002]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2007 \(Act No. 7 of 2007\)](#) on 9 January 2003]
[Amended by [Corrigenda \(Corrigendum 1 of 2008\)](#) on 8 February 2008]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2009 \(Act No. 6 of 2009\)](#) on 23 July 2009]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2012 \(Act No. 12 of 2012\)](#) on 12 July 2012]
[Amended by [Legal Education Act \(Cap. 16B\)](#) on 28 October 2012]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2014 \(Act No. 18 of 2014\)](#) on 8 December 2014]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2017 \(Act No. 11 of 2017\)](#) on 4 May 2017]
[Amended by [Companies and Insolvency Legislation \(Consequential Amendments\) Act, 2015 \(Act No. 19 of 2015\)](#) on 3 July 2017]
[Revised by [24th Annual Supplement \(Legal Notice 221 of 2023\)](#) on 31 December 2022]
[Amended by [Statute Law \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) Act, 2024 \(Act No. 3 of 2024\)](#) on 26 April 2024]

An Act of Parliament to amend and consolidate the law relating to advocates

Part I – PRELIMINARY

1 Short title

This Act may be cited as the Advocates Act.

2. Interpretation

In this Act, unless the context otherwise requires—

"advocate" means any person whose name is duly entered upon the Roll of Advocates or upon the Roll of Advocates having the rank of Senior Counsel and, for the purposes of Part IX, includes any person mentioned in [section 10](#);

"annual licence" *deleted by Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 56*;

"client" includes any person who, as a principal or on behalf of another, or as a trustee or personal representative, or in any other capacity, has power, express or implied, to retain or employ, and retains or employs, or is about to retain or employ an advocate and any person who is or may be liable to pay to an advocate any costs;

"contentious business" means any business done by an advocate in any court, civil or military, or relating to proceedings instituted or intended to be instituted in any such court, or any statutory tribunal or before any arbitrator or panel of arbitrators;

"costs" includes fees, charges, disbursements, expenses and remuneration;

"Court" means the High Court;

"Disciplinary Tribunal" means the Disciplinary Tribunal established under [section 57](#);

"non-contentious business" means any business done by an advocate other than contentious business;

"practising certificate" means a certificate issued under [section 21](#);

"Registrar" means the Chief Registrar of the Judiciary;

"Roll" means, as the case may require, the Roll of Advocates kept under [section 16](#) or the Roll of Advocates having the rank of Senior Counsel under this Act;

"Senior Counsel" means an advocate upon whom the President has conferred the rank of Senior Counsel;

"the Council of Legal Education" means the Council of Legal Education established by section 4 of the Council of Legal Education Act (Cap. 16B);

"the Council of the Society" means the Council of the Society elected under section 17 of the Law Society of Kenya Act (Cap. 18);

"the Society" means the Law Society of Kenya established by section 3 of the Law Society of Kenya Act (Cap. 18);

"unqualified person" means a person who is not qualified under [section 9](#) and includes an advocate who—

- (a) is not qualified under [section 9](#);
- (b) is not exempt under [section 10](#); and
- (c) fails to take out a practising certificate.

[Act [No. 7 of 1990](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21, Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 56, Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch., Act [No. 11 of 2017](#), Sch, Act [No. 3 of 2024](#), Sch.]

Part II – THE COUNCIL OF LEGAL EDUCATION

3. [Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.]

4. [Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.]

5. [Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.]

6. [Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.]

7. [Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.]

8. [Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.]

Part III – PROVISIONS RELATING TO THE RIGHT TO PRACTISE AS AN ADVOCATE

9. Qualifications for practising as an advocate

Subject to this Act, no person shall be qualified to act as an advocate unless—

- (a) he has been admitted as an advocate; and
- (b) his name is for the time being on the Roll; and
- (c) he has in force a practising certificate;

(d) *deleted by Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 57,*

and for the purpose of this Act a practising certificate shall be deemed not to be in force at any time while he is suspended by virtue of [section 27](#) or by an order under [section 60\(4\)](#).

[Act [No. 7 of 1990](#), Sch., Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 57.]

10. Certain officers entitled to act as advocates

Each of the following persons shall, if he holds one of the qualifications specified in paragraphs (a), (b) and (c) of [section 13\(1\)](#) at the time of his appointment to his office, be entitled in connection with the duties of his office to act as an advocate, and shall not to that extent be deemed to be an unqualified person, that is to say—

- (a) an officer in the Office of the Attorney-General or the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions;
- (b) the Chief Land Registrar, Deputy Chief Land Registrar, County Land Registrar and Land Registrars;
- (c) any person holding office in a local authority established under the Local Government Act (Repealed);
- (d) such other person, being a public officer or an officer in a public corporation, as the Attorney-General may, by notice in the *Gazette*, specify:

Provided that the officers referred to in this section shall not be entitled to charge fees for so acting.

[Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

11. Foreign advocates

- (1) The Attorney-General may, in his absolute discretion, admit to practise as an advocate, for the purpose of any specified suit or matter in or in regard to which the person so admitted has been instructed by the Attorney-General or an advocate, a practitioner who is entitled to appear before superior courts of a Commonwealth country, if such person has come or intends to come to Kenya for the purpose of appearing, acting or advising in that suit or matter and is not disqualified or suspended by virtue of this Act, and a person so admitted (hereinafter in this section referred to as a "foreign advocate") shall not, for the purpose of that suit or matter, be deemed to be an unqualified person.
- (2) No foreign advocate shall be entitled to practise until he has paid to the Registrar the prescribed admission fee.
- (3) No foreign advocate shall be entitled to practise unless he is instructed by, and if appearing in court appears with, an advocate or any person mentioned in [section 10](#), nor shall any foreign advocate be entitled to sign or file any pleadings in court.
- (4) Every foreign advocate shall, during and for the purposes of his admission, be deemed to be an advocate for the purposes of Parts VIII, IX, X, and XI:

Provided that in respect of a foreign advocate references in Part XI, or in any rules made under this Act, to the Disciplinary Committee shall be construed as references to the Chief Justice and references to striking the name of an advocate off the Roll shall be construed as references to disqualifying a foreign advocate from practice in Kenya.

- (5) Where a complaint under Part XI has been made in respect of a foreign advocate, the Chief Justice, in addition to the powers conferred upon him by that Part as modified by subsection (4), shall have power, in his discretion at the instance of the complainant or of the Council of the Society, to suspend immediately such foreign advocate from practice in Kenya pending the dismissal of the complaint or the making of a final order in respect thereof.

Part IV – ADMISSION AS ADVOCATE

12. Qualification for admission as advocate

Subject to this Act, no person shall be admitted as an advocate unless—

- (a) he is a citizen of Kenya, Rwanda, Burundi, Uganda or Tanzania; and
- (b) he is duly qualified in accordance with [section 13](#).

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

13. Professional and academic qualifications

(1) A person shall be duly qualified if—

- (a) having passed the relevant examinations of any recognized university in Kenya he holds, or has become eligible for the conferment of, a degree in law of that university; or
- (b) having passed the relevant examinations of such university, university college or other institution as the Council of Legal Education may from time to time approve, he holds, or has become eligible for conferment of, a degree in law in the grant of that university, university college or institution which the Council may in each particular case approve;

and thereafter both—

- (i) he has attended as a pupil and received from an advocate of such class as may be prescribed, instruction in the proper business, practice and employment of an advocate, and has attended such course or tuition as may be prescribed for a period which in the aggregate including such instruction, does not exceed eighteen months; and
- (ii) he has passed such examinations as the Council of Legal Education may prescribe; or
- (c) he possesses any other qualifications which are acceptable to and recognized by the Council of Legal Education;
- (d) he is an Advocate for the time being of the High Court of Uganda, the High Court of Rwanda, the High Court of Burundi or the High Court of Tanzania;
- (e) he is for the time being admitted as an advocate of the superior court of a country within the Commonwealth and—
 - (i) has practised as such in that country for a period of not less than five years; and
 - (ii) is a member in good standing of the relevant professional body in that country:

Provided that the Council may, in addition, require that a person to whom this paragraph applies undergo such training, for a period not exceeding three months, as the Council may prescribe for the purpose of adapting to the practice of law in Kenya.

(2) The Council of Legal Education may exempt any person from any or all of the requirements prescribed for the purposes of paragraph (i) or paragraph (ii) of subsection (1) upon such conditions, if any, as the Council may impose.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

14. Attorney-General and the Director of Public Prosecutions may take pupils

The Attorney-General and the Director of Public Prosecutions may take pupils in accordance with [section 13](#) and in this Part and in any regulations "advocate", in the context of pupillage, includes the Attorney-General and the Director of Public Prosecutions.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

15. Admission as an advocate

- (1) Every person who is duly qualified in accordance with this Part may apply for admission as an advocate, and the application shall be made by petition in the prescribed form, verified by oath or statutory declaration addressed to the Chief Justice, and filed with the Registrar together with a notice intimating that the petition has been so filed together with such other documents as may be prescribed and the applicant shall also deliver a copy of the petition and of any document delivered therewith to the secretary of the Council of Legal Education and to the secretary of the Society.
- (2) The notice referred to in subsection (1) shall be publicly exhibited by the Registrar for one month before any order shall be made on the petition.
- (3) Every petition made under this section shall be heard by the Chief Justice in chambers within ninety days of the expiry of the period referred to in subsection (2), and the Council of Legal Education and the Society shall have the right to be heard thereon; and, if the Chief Justice is satisfied as to the qualifications, service and moral fitness of the petitioner, he shall adjourn the hearing into open court and shall order that the petitioner be admitted as an advocate:

Provided that any period during which the High Court is on vacation shall be excluded when calculating the period of ninety days referred to in subsection (3).

- (4) On an order being made under subsection (3), and after payment by the petitioner to the Registrar of the prescribed fee, the petitioner shall take an oath or make an affirmation as an officer of the Court before the Chief Justice in such form as he shall require, and shall thereafter sign the Roll in the presence of the Registrar or a Deputy Registrar who shall add his signature as witness.
- (5) All reports, records and communications made under or in connection with this section shall be absolutely privileged.

[Act [No. 27 of 2012](#), s. 50.]

16. Custody of Roll

The Registrar shall keep the Roll of Advocates in accordance with this Act and any directions as to its form and the information to be recorded as the Chief Justice may give, and shall allow any person to inspect the Roll during office hours without payment.

Part V – SENIOR COUNSEL

17. Senior Counsel

- (1) The President may grant a letter of conferment to any person of irreproachable professional conduct who has rendered exemplary service to the legal and public service in Kenya conferring upon him the rank and dignity of Senior Counsel.
- (2) A person shall not be eligible to be a Senior Counsel unless—
 - (a) he is a duly enrolled advocate of the High Court of not less than fifteen years' standing; or
 - (b) being a person to whom [section 10](#) applies, he holds, and has held for a continuous period of not less than fifteen years, one or other of the qualifications specified in [section 13](#)(1).

- (3) The grant shall be made not later than sixty days upon receipt of a list of names submitted by the Committee on Senior Counsel through the Chief Justice.

[Act [No. 6 of 2009](#), Sch.]

18. Roll of Senior Counsel

- (1) Upon the commencement of this Act, the Registrar shall cause to be prepared, and shall thereafter maintain, a Roll of Advocates having the rank of the Senior Counsel (hereinafter called "the Roll of Senior Counsel") in accordance with this Part and any directions as to its form and the information to be recorded as the Chief Justice may give, and shall allow any person to inspect the Roll during office hours without payment.
- (2) There shall be entered in the Roll of Senior Counsel the names of all persons having the rank thereof in accordance with this Part.
- (3) Every person upon whom the rank of Senior Counsel has been conferred shall sign the Roll of Senior Counsel in the presence of the Registrar, and the Registrar shall add his signature as a witness.
- (4) The Chief Justice shall cause to be published in the *Gazette* the names of the advocates upon whom the rank of Senior Counsel is conferred.

[Act [No. 6 of 2009](#), Sch.]

19. Application of Part XI

In the application of Part XI to Senior Counsel—

- (a) all references therein to the Disciplinary Committee shall be construed as references to a Committee of three, to be appointed in each case by the Chief Justice, consisting of the Attorney-General or the Solicitor-General and two Senior Counsel and the Attorney-General or Solicitor-General shall be chairman of the Committee;
- (b) the secretary to the Disciplinary Committee shall perform the duties of secretary to any such committee; and
- (c) subsections (2) and (3) of [section 57](#) shall not have effect.

Part VI – PRECEDENCE

20. Precedence

The Attorney-General, the Director of Public Prosecutions, the Solicitor-General, Senior Counsel or Queen's Counsel according to the date of their appointment as such, the President and the Vice-president (if not a Senior Counsel) of the Society shall, in that order, take precedence of advocates who, *inter se*, shall take precedence according to the date upon which they signed their names on the Roll.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

Part VII – PRACTISING CERTIFICATE

21. Registrar to issue practising certificates

The Registrar shall issue in accordance with, but subject to, this Part and any rules made under this Act certificates authorizing the advocates named therein to practise as advocates.

[Act [No. 7 of 1990](#), Sch., Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), ss. 58, 59.]

22. Application for and issue of practising certificate

- (1) Application for a practising certificate shall be made to the Registrar—
 - (a) by delivering to him an application in duplicate, signed by the applicant specifying his name and place of business, and the date of his admission as an advocate;
 - (b) by producing evidence satisfactory to the Registrar that the applicant has paid to the Society the fee prescribed for a practising certificate and the annual subscriptions payable for the time being to the Society and to the Advocates Benevolent Association; and
 - (c) by producing a written approval signed by the Chairman of the Society stating that there is no objection to the grant of the certificate.
- (2) Subject to [section 31](#), the Registrar, if satisfied that the name of the applicant is on the Roll and that he is not for the time being suspended from practice, shall within fourteen days of the receipt by him of the application issue to the applicant a practising certificate.
- (3) The Registrar shall cause one copy of each declaration delivered to him under this section to be filed in a register kept for that purpose, and any person may inspect the register during office hours without payment.

[Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch.]

23. Issue of practising certificate to confer membership of Society

- (1) Every advocate to whom a practising certificate is issued under this Part shall thereupon and without payment of any further fee, subscription, election, admission or appointment, and notwithstanding anything contained in the Law Society of Kenya Act (Cap. 18) or in any regulations made thereunder, become a member of the Society and the Advocates Benevolent Association and be subject to any provision of law or rule of the Society and the Advocates Benevolent Association for the time being affecting the members thereof.
- (2) Every advocate who has become a member of the Society under this section shall remain a member until the end of one month after expiration of his practising certificate, unless his name, whether at his own request or otherwise, is removed from or struck off the Roll, whereupon he shall cease to be a member of the Society.
- (2A) The Society shall issue to every advocate registered with it a stamp or seal bearing the advocate's name, admission number and the year of practice in such form as may be approved by the Council of the Society and prescribed in regulations, and such stamp or seal shall be affixed on every document drawn by such advocate and lodged for registration in any registry in Kenya or issued for any other professional purpose.
- (3) An advocate who has become a member of the Society under this section and who is suspended from practice shall not be entitled during the period of the suspension to any of the rights or privileges of such membership.

[Act [No. 11 of 2017](#), Sch.]

24. Date and validity of practising certificate

- (1) Every practising certificate shall bear the date of the day on which it is issued and shall have effect from the beginning of that day:

Provided that a practising certificate which is issued during the first month of any practising year shall have effect for all purposes from the beginning of that month.
- (2) The practising year shall be from the 1st January to 31st December:

Provided that the Council of the Society, with the approval of the Chief Justice, may by order alter the practising year, and the order may make such transitional provision in regard to incidental matters as may be expedient.

- (3) Every practising certificate shall expire at the end of the practising year in which it was issued:

Provided that, where the name of an advocate is removed from or struck off the Roll, the practising certificate (if any) of that advocate shall expire forthwith.

- (4) The Registrar shall enter upon the Roll a note of the date of the issue of every practising certificate.

25. Discretion of Registrar to issue practising certificate in special cases

- (1) Subject to subsection (3) and to [section 28](#)(5), subsection (2) shall have effect where an advocate applies for a practising certificate—
- (a) when for twelve months or more he has ceased to hold a practising certificate in force; or
 - (b) whilst he is an undischarged bankrupt or a receiving order in bankruptcy is in force against him; or
 - (c) when, having been suspended from practice or having had his name removed from or struck off the Roll, the period of his suspension has expired or his name has been restored to the Roll, as the case may be; or
 - (d) not having held a practising certificate in force within twelve months next following the date of his admission as an advocate; or
 - (e) whilst he is a person to whom the powers and provisions of the Mental Health Act ([Cap. 248](#)) relating to management and administration apply; or
 - (f) without having paid a penalty or costs ordered by the Disciplinary Committee to be paid by him; or
 - (g) after having been adjudicated a bankrupt and obtained his discharge or after having entered into a composition with his creditors or a deed of arrangement for the benefit of his creditors; or
 - (h) after having had given against him any judgment which involves the payments of moneys, not being a judgment—
 - (i) limited to the payment of costs; or
 - (ii) as to the whole effect of which upon him he is entitled to indemnity or relief from some other person; or
 - (iii) evidence of the satisfaction of which, within seven days of the giving of such judgment, has been produced to the Registrar.
- (2) The applicant shall give to the Registrar and to the secretary of the Society not less than six weeks before his application for a practising certificate notice of his intention to apply therefor.
- (3) The Council of the Society shall make representations or submit a recommendation to the Registrar with respect to any application made under this section, and any such representations shall be taken into account by the Registrar and shall be absolutely privileged.
- (4) The Registrar may in his discretion—
- (i) grant or refuse any application made under this section; or

- (ii) decide to issue a practising certificate to the applicant upon such terms and conditions as he may think fit;

and, where the Registrar decides to issue a certificate subject to conditions, he may, if he thinks fit, postpone the issue of the certificate pending the hearing and determination of any appeal under [section 26\(2\)](#):

Provided that in a case such as is mentioned in paragraph (b) or (h) of subsection (1), where on appeal has been made to the appropriate court against the order or judgment in question the Registrar shall not refuse the application before the determination of that appeal.

- (5) Where a practising certificate free of conditions is issued by the Registrar under subsection (2) to an advocate in relation to whom that subsection has effect by virtue of any of the particular circumstances mentioned in paragraphs (a), (c), (d), (g) and (h) of subsection (1), subsections (2), (3) and (4) shall not thereafter have effect in relation to that advocate by virtue of those circumstances.

[Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch.]

26. Appeals in connection with issue of practising certificate

- (1) If in any case, not being a case to which [section 25](#) applies, the Registrar on an application duly made to him refuses or neglects to issue a practising certificate the applicant may apply to the Chief Justice who may make such an order in the matter as is just.
- (2) Where under [section 25](#) the Registrar either refuses to grant a practising certificate or decides to issue that certificate subject to terms and conditions, the applicant may by petition presented within one month after being notified of the decision of the Registrar, and in such manner and subject to such regulations as the Chief Justice may from time to time direct, appeal against that decision to the Chief Justice, who may—
 - (a) affirm the decision of the Registrar; or
 - (b) direct the Registrar to issue a certificate to the applicant free from terms and conditions or upon such terms and conditions as the Chief Justice may think fit; or
 - (c) direct the Registrar not to issue a certificate; or
 - (d) if a certificate has been issued, by order suspend that certificate; or
 - (e) make such other order as he may think fit.

27. Suspension of practising certificate in certain circumstances

The making by the Disciplinary Committee or the Court of an order suspending an advocate from practice shall operate, and the adjudication in bankruptcy of an advocate shall operate immediately, to suspend any practising certificate of that advocate for the time being in force.

28. Duration of suspension of practising certificate

- (1) Subject to this section, where a practising certificate has become suspended by an order under [section 26\(2\)](#) or by virtue of [section 27](#), that suspension shall continue until the certificate expires.
- (2) The suspension of a practising certificate by virtue of [section 27](#) by reason of an adjudication in bankruptcy shall terminate if the adjudication is annulled and a certified copy of the order annulling the adjudication has been served on the Registrar.
- (3) Where an advocate's practising certificate has become suspended—
 - (a) by an order under [section 26\(2\)](#); or
 - (b) by virtue of [section 27](#) by reason of his adjudication in bankruptcy, the advocate may at any time before the certificate expires (and, in the case of adjudication in bankruptcy, while the

adjudication remains unannulled) apply to the Registrar to terminate the suspension of the practising certificate, giving at the same time notice to the secretary of the Society that the application has been made.

- (4) The Council of the Society may make representations or submit recommendations to the Registrar with respect to any application made under this section, and the representations or recommendations shall be absolutely privileged.
- (5) The Registrar may in his discretion—
 - (i) by order terminate the suspension either unconditionally or upon such terms and conditions as he may think fit; or
 - (ii) refuse the application.
- (6) If, on an application by an advocate under subsection (3), the Registrar refuses the application or terminates the suspension subject to terms or conditions, the advocate may, by petition presented in such manner and subject to such regulations as the Chief Justice may from time to time direct, appeal against the decision of the Registrar to the Chief Justice, who may—
 - (a) affirm the decision of the Registrar; or
 - (b) terminate the suspension either unconditionally or upon such terms and conditions as he may think fit.
- (7) Where an advocate's practising certificate has become suspended by virtue of [section 27](#) by reason of his suspension from practice and the suspension of his practising certificate is terminated unconditionally under subsection (5) or subsection (6), then, notwithstanding paragraph (c) of subsection (1) of [section 25](#), subsections (2), (3) and (4) of [section 25](#) shall not thereafter have effect in relation to that advocate by virtue of that suspension from practice and the expiry of the period thereof.

29. Publication of suspension or termination of suspension of practising certificate in certain cases

Where an advocate's practising certificate has become suspended—

- (a) by an order under [section 26\(2\)](#); or
- (b) by virtue of [section 27](#) by reason of his adjudication in bankruptcy, the Registrar shall forthwith cause notice of that suspension to be published in the *Gazette* and a note thereof to be entered against the name of the advocate in the Roll; and where that suspension is terminated under subsection (2), subsection (3) or subsection (4) of [section 28](#), the Registrar shall forthwith cause a note of that termination to be entered against the name of the advocate in the Roll and, if so requested in writing by the advocate, a note thereof to be published in the *Gazette*.

30. Evidence as to holding of practising certificate

- (1) Any list purporting to be published by authority of the Registrar and to contain the names of advocates who have obtained practising certificates for the current year before the 1st February in that year shall, until the contrary is proved, be evidence that the persons named therein as advocates holding such certificates as aforesaid for the current year are advocates holding such certificates.
- (2) The absence from any such list of the name of any person shall, until the contrary is proved, be evidence that that person is not qualified to practise as an advocate under a certificate for the current year, but in the case of any such person an extract from the Roll certified as correct by the Registrar shall be evidence of the facts appearing in the extract.

30A. [Repealed by Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 60.]

30B. [Repealed by Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 61.]

30C. [Repealed by Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 62.]

Part VIII – PROVISIONS WITH RESPECT TO UNQUALIFIED PERSONS ACTING AS ADVOCATES AND OFFENCES BY ADVOCATES

31. Unqualified person not to act as advocate

- (1) Subject to [section 83](#), no unqualified person shall act as an advocate, or as such cause any summons or other process to issue, or institute, carry on or defend any suit or other proceedings in the name of any other person in any court of civil or criminal jurisdiction.
- (2) Any person who contravenes subsection (1) shall—
 - (a) be deemed to be in contempt of the court in which he so acts or in which the suit or matter in relation to which he so acts is brought or taken, and may be punished accordingly; and
 - (b) be incapable of maintaining any suit for any costs in respect of anything done by him in the course of so acting; and
 - (c) in addition be guilty of an offence.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

32. [Repealed by Act [No. 27 of 2012](#), s. 50.]

32A. Employment as in-house Advocate

- (1) A person who is qualified to act as an advocate under this Act may be employed as an in-house advocate.
- (2) A person who is employed as an in-house advocate shall—
 - (a) be an independent professional legal advisor to his or her employer; and
 - (b) not charge fees for services rendered below the minimum prescribed fees under [section 44](#).

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

32B. Standards of work and remuneration

- (1) The Chief Justice shall, on the recommendation of the Council of the Society, prescribe—
 - (a) the standards of work that may be performed by a person employed as an in-house advocate under this Act; and
 - (b) the criteria for determining the remuneration payable to an in-house counsel by an employer.
- (2) The employer of an in-house advocate shall not determine the remuneration of such advocate otherwise than in accordance with the criteria prescribed under subsection (1)(b).
- (3) Notwithstanding subsection (2), the employer of an in-house advocate may, in making a determination under subsection (2), offer the advocate remuneration which is higher than that prescribed.
- (4) Subject to subsection (3), a person who contravenes subsection (2) commits an offence.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

33. Penalty for pretending to be advocate

Any unqualified person who wilfully pretends to be, or takes or uses any name, title, addition or description implying that he is, qualified or recognized by law as qualified to act as an advocate shall be guilty of an offence.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

34. Unqualified person not to prepare certain documents or instruments

- (1) No unqualified person shall, either directly or indirectly, take instructions or draw or prepare any document or instrument—
 - (a) relating to the conveyancing of property; or
 - (b) for, or in relation to, the formation of any limited liability company, whether private or public; or
 - (c) for, or in relation to, an agreement of partnership or the dissolution thereof; or
 - (d) for the purpose of filing or opposing a grant of probate or letters of administration; or
 - (e) for which a fee is prescribed by any order made by the Chief Justice under [section 44](#); or
 - (f) relating to any other legal proceedings;

nor shall any such person accept or receive, directly or indirectly, any fee, gain or reward for the taking of any such instruction or for the drawing or preparation of any such document or instrument:

Provided that this subsection shall not apply to—

- (i) any public officer drawing or preparing documents or instruments in the course of his duty; or
 - (ii) any person employed by an advocate and acting within the scope of that employment; or
 - (iii) any person employed merely to engross any document or instrument.
- (2) Any money received by an unqualified person in contravention of this section may be recovered by the person by whom the same was paid as a civil debt recoverable summarily.
- (3) Any person who contravenes subsection (1) shall be guilty of an offence.
- (4) This section shall not apply to—
 - (a) a will or other testamentary instrument; or
 - (b) a transfer of stock or shares containing no trust or limitation thereof.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

34A. Additional endorsements

Subject to [section 10](#), an advocate who holds a current practising certificate shall not file any legal documents in any registry under any law which requires filing of such document by an advocate, or issue such document for any other professional purpose, unless there is affixed on each such document the stamp or seal issued by the Society under [section 23\(2A\)](#).

[Act [No. 11 of 2017](#), Sch.]

34B. Validity of legal documents

- (1) A practising advocate who is not exempt under [section 10](#) and who fails to take out a practising certificate in any year, commits an act of professional misconduct.
- (2) Notwithstanding any other provisions of this Act, nothing shall affect the validity of any legal document drawn or prepared by an advocate without a valid practising certificate.
- (3) For the purpose of this section, "legal document" includes pleadings, affidavits, depositions, applications, deeds and other related instruments, filed in any registry under any law requiring filing by an advocate.

[Act [No. 11 of 2017](#), Sch.]

35. Instruments to be endorsed with name and address of drawer

- (1) Every person who draws or prepares, or causes to be drawn or prepared, any document or instrument referred to in [section 34](#)(1) shall at the same time endorse or cause to be endorsed thereon his name and address, or the name and address of the firm of which he is a partner and any person omitting so to do shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding five thousand shillings in the case of an unqualified person or a fine not exceeding five hundred shillings in the case of an advocate:

Provided that, in the case of any document or instrument drawn, prepared or engrossed by a person employed, and whilst acting within the scope of his employment, by an advocate or by a firm of advocates, the name and address to be endorsed thereon shall be the name and address of such advocate or firm.

- (2) The Registrar, the Chief Land Registrar, Deputy Chief Land Registrar, County Land Registrar, Land Registrars, the Registrar-General, the Registrar of Companies and any other registering authority shall refuse to accept or recognize any document or instrument referred to in [section 34](#)(1) unless such document or instrument is endorsed in accordance with this section.

36. Undercutting

- (1) Any advocate who holds himself out or allows himself to be held out, directly or indirectly and whether or not by name, as being prepared to do professional business at less than the remuneration prescribed, by order, under this Act shall be guilty of an offence.
- (2) No advocate shall charge or accept, otherwise than in part payment, any fee or other consideration in respect of professional business which is less than the remuneration prescribed, by order, under this Act.

37. Sharing profits

Any advocate who agrees to share his profits in respect of any professional business, whether contentious or non-contentious, with any person not being an advocate or other duly qualified legal practitioner (by whatever name called) shall be guilty of an offence:

Provided that this section shall not apply to the payment of any bonus to any of his employees by an advocate, being a bonus based or calculated on the advocate's total earnings or profits in respect of any period.

38. Touts

- (1) Any unqualified person who, in consideration of any payment or other advantage to himself or any other person, procures or attempts to procure the employment of an advocate as such in any suit or matter or solicits from an advocate any such payment or advantage in consideration of such employment shall be deemed to be a tout for the purposes of this section.

- (2) The Chief Justice may, if satisfied that any person has acted as a tout, by order exclude such person from the employment by an advocate in his practice as such.

39. Advocate not to act as agent for unqualified person

Any advocate who acts as agent in any suit, or in any matter in bankruptcy, for any unqualified person, or permits his name, or that of any firm of which he is a partner, to be made use of in any such suit or matter, upon the account or for the profit of any unqualified person or who does any other act enabling an unqualified person to appear, act or practise in any respect as an advocate in such suit or matter, or who in any way assists any unqualified person in any cause or matter in which he knows that such person is contravening or intends to contravene this Act, shall be guilty of an offence.

40. No costs recoverable where unqualified person acts as advocate

No costs in respect of anything done by an unqualified person in contravention of this Part shall be recoverable in any suit or matter by any person.

41. Employment by advocate of persons struck-off the Roll or suspended

- (1) No advocate shall, in connection with his practice as an advocate, without the written permission of the Council of the Society, which may be given for such period and subject to such conditions as the Council thinks fit, employ or remunerate any person who to his knowledge is disqualified from practising as an advocate by reason of the fact that his name has been struck off the Roll, otherwise than at his own request, or is suspended from practising as an advocate.
- (2) An advocate aggrieved by the refusal of the Council of the Society to grant any permission referred to in subsection (1), or by conditions attached by the Council to the grant thereof, may appeal to the Chief Justice, who may confirm the refusal or the conditions, as the case may be, or may, in lieu of the Council, grant such permission for such period and subject to such conditions as he thinks fit.
- (3) If any advocate acts in contravention of this section or of the conditions subject to which any permission has been given thereunder he shall be liable to proceedings under [section 60](#).

42. Penalty for failure to disclose fact of having been struck-off, etc.

- (1) Any person who, whilst he is disqualified from practising as an advocate by reason of the fact that he has been struck off the Roll, otherwise than at his own request, or is suspended from practising as an advocate, seeks or accepts employment by an advocate in connection with the advocate's practice without previously informing him that he is so disqualified as aforesaid shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding fifty thousand shillings, or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding two years, or to both.
- (2) Deleted by Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

43. Offences by bodies corporate

- (1) If any act is done by a body corporate or by any director, officer or servant thereof, of such a nature or in such a manner as to be calculated to imply that the body corporate is qualified, or recognized by law as qualified, to act as an advocate, the body corporate shall be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding fifty thousand shillings for each such offence, and, in the case of an act done by any director, officer or servant of the corporation, he shall, without prejudice to the liability of the corporation, be guilty of an offence and liable to a fine not exceeding twenty-five thousand shillings for each such offence.
- (2) In this Part, references to unqualified persons and to persons include references to bodies corporate.

Part IX – REMUNERATION OF ADVOCATES

44. Chief Justice may make orders prescribing remuneration

- (1) The Council of the Society may make recommendation to the Chief Justice on all matters relating to the remuneration of advocates, and the Chief Justice, having considered the same, may by order, prescribe and regulate in such manner as he thinks fit the remuneration of advocates in respect of all professional business, whether contentious or non-contentious.
- (2) An order made under this section in respect of non-contentious business may, as regards the mode of remuneration, prescribe that it shall be according to a scale of rates of commission or percentage, varying or not in different classes of business or by a gross sum, or by a fixed sum for each document prepared or perused, without regard to length, or in any other mode, or partly in one mode or partly in another, and may regulate the amount of remuneration with reference to all or any of the following, among other, considerations, that is to say—
 - (a) the position of the party for whom the advocate is concerned in the business, that is, whether as vendor or purchaser, lessor or lessee, mortgagor or mortgagee, and the like;
 - (b) the place where, and the circumstances in which, the business or any part thereof is transacted;
 - (c) the amount of the capital money or rent to which the business relates;
 - (d) the skill, labour and responsibility involved therein on the part of the advocate;
 - (e) the number and importance of the documents prepared or perused, without regard to length.
- (3) An order made under this section may authorize and regulate—
 - (a) the taking by an advocate from his client of security for payment of any remuneration to be ascertained by taxation or otherwise, which may become due to him under any such order; and
 - (b) the allowance of interest.
- (4) So long as an order made under this section in respect of non-contentious business is in operation, taxation of bills of costs of advocates in respect of non-contentious business shall, subject to [section 45](#), be regulated by that order.

45. Agreements with respect to remuneration

- (1) Subject to [section 46](#) and whether or not an order is in force under [section 44](#), an advocate and his client may—
 - (a) before, after or in the course of any contentious business, make an agreement fixing the amount of the advocate's remuneration in respect thereof;
 - (b) before, after or in the course of any contentious business in a civil court, make an agreement fixing the amount of the advocate's instruction fee in respect thereof or his fees for appearing in court or both;
 - (c) before, after or in the course of any proceedings in a criminal court or a court martial, make an agreement fixing the amount of the advocate's fee for the conduct thereof, and such agreement shall be valid and binding on the parties provided it is in writing and signed by the client or his agent duly authorized in that behalf.
- (2) A client may apply by chamber summons to the Court to have the agreement set aside or varied on the grounds that it is harsh and unconscionable, exorbitant or unreasonable, and every such application shall be heard before a judge sitting with two assessors, who shall be advocates of not less than five years' standing appointed by the Registrar after consultation with the chairman of the

Society for each application and on any such application the Court, whose decision shall be final, shall have power to order—

- (a) that the agreement be upheld; or
 - (b) that the agreement be varied by substituting for the amount of the remuneration fixed by the agreement such amount as the Court may deem just; or
 - (c) that the agreement be set aside; or
 - (d) that the costs in question be taxed by the Registrar, and that the costs of the application be paid by such party as it thinks fit.
- (2A) An application under subsection (2) may be made within one year after the making of the agreement, or within three months after a demand in writing by the advocate for payment under the agreement by way of rendering a fee note or otherwise, whichever is the later.
- (3) An agreement made by virtue of this section, if made in respect of contentious business, shall not affect the amount of, or any rights or remedies for the recovery of, any costs payable by the client to, or to the client by, any person other than the advocate, and that person may, unless he has otherwise agreed, require any such costs to be taxed according to the rules for the time being in force for the taxation thereof:

Provided that any such agreement shall be produced on demand to a taxing officer and the client shall not be entitled to recover from any other person, under any order for the payment of any costs to which the agreement relates, more than the amount payable by him to his advocate in respect thereof under the agreement.

- (4) Where any agreement made by virtue of this section is made by the client as the guardian or committee of, or trustee under deed or will for, any person whose property will be chargeable with the whole or any part of the amount payable under the agreement, the advocate shall, before payment thereunder is accepted or demanded and in any event within six months after its due date, apply by chamber summons to the Court for approval of such agreement, and every such application shall be dealt with in accordance with subsection (2).
- (5) If, after an advocate has performed part only of the business to which any agreement made by virtue of this section relates, such advocate dies or becomes incapable of acting, or the client changes his advocate as, notwithstanding the agreement, he shall be entitled to do, any party, or the legal personal representatives of any party, to such agreement may apply by chamber summons to the Court to have the agreement set aside or varied, and every such application shall be dealt with in accordance with subsection (2):

Provided that, in the case of a client changing his advocate, the Court shall have regard to the circumstances in which the change has taken place and, unless of opinion that there has been default, negligence, improper delay or other conduct on the part of the advocate affording to the client reasonable ground for changing his advocate, shall allow the advocate the full amount of the remuneration agreed to be paid to him.

- (6) Subject to this section, the costs of an advocate in any case where an agreement has been made by virtue of this section shall not be subject to taxation nor to [section 48](#).

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

46. Invalid agreements

Nothing in this Act shall give validity to—

- (a) any purchase by an advocate of the interest, or any part of the interest, of his client in any suit or other contentious proceeding; or
- (b) any agreement relieving any advocate from responsibility for professional negligence or any other responsibility to which he would otherwise be subject as an advocate; or

- (c) any agreement by which an advocate retained or employed to prosecute or defend any suit or other contentious proceeding stipulates for payment only in the event of success in such suit or proceeding or that the advocate shall be remunerated at different rates according to the success or failure thereof; or
- (d) any agreement by which an advocate agrees to accept, in respect of professional business, any fee or other consideration which shall be less than the remuneration prescribed by any order under [section 44](#) respect of that business or more than twenty-five per centum of the general damages recovered less the party and party costs as taxed or agreed; or
- (e) any disposition, contract, settlement, conveyance, delivery, dealing or transfer that is, under the Insolvency Act (Cap. 53) void or ineffective against the Official Receiver or a bankruptcy trustee or an interim trustee in proceedings under that Act.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 19 of 2015](#), s. 3.]

47. Power of court to order advocate to deliver his bill and to deliver up deed

- (1) The jurisdiction of the Court to make orders for the delivery by an advocate of a bill of costs, and for the delivery up of or otherwise in relation to, any deeds, documents or papers in his possession, custody or power, is hereby declared to extend to cases in which no business has been done by him in the Court.
- (2) In this section and in sections [48](#), [49](#) and [50](#) "advocate" includes the executors, administrators and assignees of the advocate in question.

48. Action for recovery of costs

- (1) Subject to this Act, no suit shall be brought for the recovery of any costs due to an advocate or his firm until the expiry of one month after a bill for such costs, which may be in summarized form, signed by the advocate or a partner in his firm, has been delivered or sent by registered post to the client, unless there is reasonable cause to be verified by affidavit filed with the plaint, for believing that the party chargeable therewith is about to quit Kenya or abscond from the local limits of the Court's jurisdiction, in which event action may be commenced before expiry of the period of one month.
- (2) Subject to subsection (1), a suit may be brought for the recovery of costs due to an advocate in any court of competent jurisdiction.
- (3) Notwithstanding any other provisions of this Act, a bill of costs between an advocate and a client may be taxed notwithstanding that no suit for recovery of costs has been filed.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

49. Procedure in action where quantum of costs is challenged by defence

Where, in the absence of an agreement for remuneration made by virtue of [section 45](#), a suit has been brought by an advocate for the recovery of any costs and a defence is filed disputing the reasonableness or quantum thereof—

- (a) no judgment shall be entered for the plaintiff, except by consent, until the costs have been taxed and certified by the taxing officer;
- (b) unless the bill of costs on which the suit is based is fully itemised, the plaintiff shall file a fully itemized bill of the costs within fourteen days from the date of service of the defence, or such further period as may be allowed by the court, and shall serve a copy thereof on the defendant, and, if the total amount of such bill exceeds the amount sued for, the prayer of the plaintiff shall, subject to the court's pecuniary jurisdiction, be deemed to be increased accordingly and all consequential amendments to the pleadings may be made;

- (c) no court or filing fee shall be payable on filing a bill of costs required by this section, but, if thereby the amount for which judgment is prayed in the plaint is deemed to be increased under paragraph (b), the plaintiff shall pay to the court such court or filing fee as may be appropriate to the increase; and
- (d) at any time after the bill of costs has been filed, and before the suit has been set down for hearing, any party to the action may take out a summons for directions as to whether such bill should be taxed by the taxing officer before the suit is heard.

50. Taxation on application of third parties, beneficiaries under trust, etc.

- (1) Where a person other than the person who is the party chargeable with a bill of costs is liable to pay the bill either to the advocate or to the party chargeable with the bill, or where a person is interested in any property in the hands or under the control of a trustee, executor or administrator, out of which property the trustee, executor or administrator has paid or is liable to pay the bill, that person or his administrators, executors or assignees may apply to the Court for an order for the taxation of the bill as if he were the party chargeable therewith, and the Court, having regard to the extent and nature of the interest of the person, may make any order thereon which it would have been competent to make if the application had been made by that party:

Provided that no order for taxation of a bill shall be made under this section in any case where—

- (i) the bill has previously been taxed; or
 - (ii) the application is made more than six months after the date on which the bill was rendered to the party chargeable therewith or three months after the date on which the bill was paid, or the date when the party making the application became entitled to do so, whichever is the earliest.
- (2) If an applicant under subsection (1) pays or has paid any money to the advocate in respect of a bill of costs payable out of property in the hands or under the control, of a trustee, executor or administrator he shall have the same right to be paid that money by the trustee, executor or administrator chargeable with the bill as the advocate had.
- (3) The Court may, if it orders taxation of the bill under this section, order the advocate to deliver to the applicant a copy of the bill upon payment of the costs of that copy.

51. General provisions as to taxation

- (1) Every application for an order for the taxation of an advocate's bill or for the delivery of such a bill and the delivering up of any deeds, documents and papers by an advocate shall be made in the matter of that advocate.
- (2) The certificate of the taxing officer by whom any bill has been taxed shall, unless it is set aside or altered by the Court, be final as to the amount of the costs covered thereby, and the Court may make such order in relation thereto as it thinks fit, including, in a case where the retainer is not disputed, an order that judgment be entered for the sum certified to be due with costs.

52. Charging orders

Any court in which an advocate has been employed to prosecute or defend any suit or matter may at any time declare the advocate entitled to a charge on the property recovered or preserved through his instrumentality for his taxed costs in reference to that suit or matter, and may make orders for the taxation of the costs and for raising money to pay or for paying the costs out of the property so charged as it thinks fit, and all conveyances and acts done to defeat, or operating to defeat, that charge shall, except in the case of a conveyance to a bona fide purchaser for value without notice, be void as against the advocate:

Provided that no order shall be made if the right to recover the costs is barred by limitation.

Part X – COMPLAINTS COMMISSION

53. Establishment of Complaints Commission

- (1) There is hereby established a Complaints Commission (in this Part referred to as "the Commission") which shall consist of such commissioner or commissioners as shall be appointed by the President for the purpose of enquiring into complaints against any advocate, firm of advocates, or any member or employees thereof.
- (2) If a single commissioner is appointed under subsection (1) he shall be a person who is qualified to be appointed as a Judge of the High Court under Chapter Ten of the Constitution, and if more than one commissioner is appointed then one commissioner shall be so qualified.
- (3) The Commission may require any person, whom it considers necessary for the purpose of carrying out its duties under this section, to assist it in so doing.
- (3A) Any person who, without lawful excuse, fails or refuses to assist the Commission when required to do so under subsection (3) shall be guilty of an offence.
- (4) It shall be the duty of the Commission to receive and consider a complaint made by any person, regarding the conduct of any advocate, firm of advocates, or any member or employee thereof; and —
 - (a) if it appears to the Commission that there is no substance in the complaint it shall reject the same forthwith; or
 - (b) if it appears to the Commission whether before or after investigation that there is substance in the complaint but that the matter complained of constitutes or appears to constitute a disciplinary offence it shall forthwith refer the matter to the Disciplinary Committee for appropriate action by it under Part XI; or
 - (c) if it appears to the Commission that there is substance in the complaint but that it does not constitute a disciplinary offence it shall forthwith notify the person or firm against whom the complaint has been made of the particulars of the complaint and call upon such person or firm to answer the complaint within such reasonable period as shall be specified by the Commission in such notification; or
 - (d) upon the expiration of the period specified under paragraph (c), the Commission shall proceed to investigate the matter for which purpose it shall have power to summon witnesses, to require the production of such documents as it may deem necessary, to examine witnesses on oath and generally take all such steps as it may consider proper and necessary for the purpose of its inquiry and shall, after hearing any submissions made to it by or on behalf of the complainant and the person or firm against whom the complaint has been made, make such an order or award in accordance with this section as it shall in the circumstances of the case consider just and proper; or
 - (e) if it appears to the Commission that there is substance in a complaint but that the circumstances of the case do not disclose a disciplinary offence with which the Disciplinary Committee can properly deal and that the Commission itself should not deal with the matter but that the proper remedy for the complainant is to refer the matter to the courts for appropriate redress the Commission shall forthwith so advise the complainant.
- (5) In all cases which do not appear to the Commission to be of serious or aggravated nature, the Commission shall endeavour to promote reconciliation and encourage and facilitate an amicable settlement between the parties to the complaint.
- (6) If the Commission considers that the complainant has suffered loss or damage by reason of the advocate's conduct, the Commission may, by order, award such complainant compensation or reimbursement not exceeding one hundred thousand shillings.

- (6A) An order made under subsection (6) shall be registered with the Court and shall thereupon be enforceable in the same manner as an order of the Court to the like effect.
- (6B) Where the matter before the Commission relates to surrender of funds or property by an advocate to a client, the Commission may order the surrender of all refunds or property which the advocate does not dispute:
- Provided that this subsection shall not apply where the complainant has filed a civil suit against the advocate in respect of the same funds or property.
- (6C) An advocate against whom an order is made under this section and who has not appealed against such order under [section 62](#) may apply to the Disciplinary Committee for a review of the Order.
- (6D) The Commission may, in hearing a complaint against an advocate, order such advocate to produce to the Commission a detailed fee note for purposes of taxation of the bill of costs:
- Provided that where the advocate fails to produce such fee note within 14 days from the date of such order, the Commission may assess the advocate's fee in such sum as it deems fit.
- (6E) The Commission may investigate the accounts of an advocate against whom a complaint has been made and for that purpose may order such advocate to produce all relevant books and documents to the Commission or to an accountant engaged before the Commission in that behalf.
- (7) The Commission may issue a warrant for the levy of the amount of any sum ordered to be paid by virtue of this section on the immovable and movable property of the person or firm by whom the compensation is ordered to be paid by distress and sale under warrant, and such warrant shall be enforced as if it was a warrant issued by the Court.
- (8) Any party aggrieved by a decision or order of the Commission under this section may appeal to the High Court and the determination of any such appeal shall be final.
- (9) The Commission shall publish a quarterly report as to the complaints dealt with by it in that quarter and the report shall be made in such manner and be in such form as shall be prescribed by rules made under subsection (3) of [section 54](#).

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

53A. Remuneration of Commissioner

- (1) There shall be paid to the Commissioner such remuneration by way of salary, allowance, pension or gratuity as shall be determined by the President.
- (2) The remuneration referred to in subsection (1) shall be paid out of moneys provided by Parliament.

[Act [No. 21 of 1990](#), Sch.]

54. Secretary and staff of Commission and rules relating thereto

- (1) There shall be a secretary to the Commission who shall be appointed by the Attorney-General.
- (2) The Attorney-General shall provide such public officers as are necessary for the proper and efficient exercise of the duties and functions of the Commission.
- (3) The Attorney-General may make rules regulating the structure and operation of the Commission and for the carrying into effect its functions under this Part.

Part XI – DISCIPLINE

55. Advocates to be officers of Court

Every advocate and every person otherwise entitled to act as an advocate shall be an officer of the Court and shall be subject to the jurisdiction thereof and, subject to this Act, to the jurisdiction of the Disciplinary Tribunal:

Provided that the persons mentioned in [section 10](#), other than those included in paragraph (c) of that section, shall not be subject to the jurisdiction of the Disciplinary Tribunal.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

56. Savings of disciplinary powers of Court

Nothing in this Act shall supersede, lessen or interfere with the powers vested in the Chief Justice or any of the judges of the Court to deal with misconduct or offences by an advocate, or any person entitled to act as such, committed during, or in the course of, or relating to, proceedings before the Chief Justice or any judge.

57. Establishment of Disciplinary Tribunal

- (1) There is established a tribunal to be known as the Disciplinary Tribunal (in this Part referred to as "the Tribunal") which shall consist of—
 - (a) the Attorney-General;
 - (aa) *deleted by Act [No. 18 of 2014](#), Sch.;*
 - (b) the Solicitor-General or a person deputed by the Attorney-General; and
 - (c) six advocates (other than the President, Vice-president or secretary of the Society), of not less than ten years standing, one of whom shall be an advocate who does not ordinarily practise in Nairobi, all of whom shall be elected and shall hold office for three years and be eligible for re-election;
 - (d) *deleted by Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch.*
- (1A) The members of the Tribunal shall be paid such remuneration, fees or allowances for expenses as the Attorney-General, in consultation with the National Treasury, may authorise out of monies provided by Parliament for that purpose.
- (2) During the illness, or temporary absence from Kenya, of any of its elected members, the Tribunal may nominate any advocate who is qualified for election as a member of the Tribunal to act as a temporary member of the Tribunal.
- (3) In the event of there being any complaint or matter pending before the Tribunal at the date of retirement of any member and such member being a member of a tribunal thereof which had, prior to such date, entered upon the hearing thereof in accordance with [section 60](#), that member shall, in the event of his not being re-elected, be deemed to remain in office for the purpose only of such complaint or matter and shall so remain until such complaint or matter has been finally disposed of.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3), a complaint or matter shall be deemed to be pending if under consideration by the Tribunal, and a complaint or matter shall be deemed to have been finally disposed of—
 - (a) in the case of an application under [section 59](#), or a complaint under [section 60](#), upon the making of a final order; or

- (b) in the case of a matter arising under [section 71](#), when the Chief Justice has signified his decision thereon; or
- (c) in the case of an application under [section 72](#), upon the final conclusion of the proceedings relating thereto before the Committee or the Court, as the case may be; or
- (d) in any other case, upon the final determination thereof by the Committee.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch., Act [No. 18 of 2014](#), Sch.]

58. Proceedings of Tribunal

- (1) The Tribunal may, subject to subsection (2), act as a tribunal of either three or five members, and may require the chairman or vice-chairman of the Society or both or any other member of the Council of the Society, to sit as an additional member or members of the Tribunal to constitute the tribunal for the purposes of any complaint or matter where, on the grounds of availability or convenience, a tribunal would not otherwise be available.
- (2) The Attorney-General or Solicitor-General shall be the chairman of the Tribunal and shall preside at all meetings at which he is present, and in absence of the Attorney-General or the Solicitor-General the person deputed by the Attorney-General under [section 57\(1\)\(b\)](#) shall be chairman of that meeting:

Provided that if both the Attorney-General and the Solicitor-General or any person deputed by the Attorney-General under subsection (1) of [section 57](#) are unable to be present, the tribunal shall appoint a chairman from the members present.

- (3) The secretary of the Society shall be the secretary of the Tribunal and his remuneration, if any, shall be paid by the Society:

Provided that the Tribunal may, in the case of absence or inability to act of the secretary, appoint any person entitled to act as an advocate to act as secretary to the Tribunal during the period of such absence or inability to act and in such case the remuneration, if any, of the person so appointed shall be paid by the Society.

- (4) For the purposes of any application or complaint made to it under this Part, the Tribunal may administer oaths or affirmations, and the complainant and the advocate to whom a complaint relates, and an applicant making any application to the Tribunal, may take out a summons to give evidence or to produce documents, but no person shall be compellable under any such summons to produce any document which he could not legally be compelled to produce at the trial of a suit.
- (5) All proceedings before the Tribunal shall be deemed for the purposes of Chapter XI of the Penal Code ([Cap. 63](#)) to be judicial proceedings and for the purposes of the Evidence Act ([Cap. 80](#)) to be legal proceedings.
- (6) The Tribunal may make rules for regulating the making to the Tribunal, and the hearing and determination by the Tribunal, of applications or complaints under this Part or with respect to matters incidental to or consequential upon its Orders.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

58A. Establishment of Regional Disciplinary Committees

- (1) There are hereby established Disciplinary Committees (in this Part referred to as "Regional Committees") in five representative regions, other than Nairobi, identified by the society.
- (2) Each Regional Disciplinary Committee shall have a jurisdiction concurrent to that of the Disciplinary Committee established under section 57 of the Advocates Act in their respective regions, and shall exercise the same functions and have the same powers and duties set out under this Part or under any other written law.

- (3) Each Regional Committee shall consist of five advocates (other than the Chairman, Vice-Chairman or Secretary of the Society) of not less than ten years' standing, all of whom shall be elected by the various chapters or regional representatives of the Society, who shall hold office for two years and shall be eligible for re-election.
- (4) The provision of this Part shall apply accordingly to the Committee and the Regional Committees, and the two shall be used interchangeably where reference is made to one or in any other written law.

[Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch.]

59. Application for removal of name from the Roll

- (1) An advocate may make an application to the Tribunal to procure his name to be removed from the Roll.
- (2) On the hearing of an application under subsection (1), the Tribunal may make an order that the name of such advocate be removed from the Roll and may make such other order in relation to the case as it may think fit.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

60. Complaints against advocates

- (1) A complaint against an advocate of professional misconduct, which expression includes disgraceful or dishonourable conduct incompatible with the status of an advocate, may be made to the Tribunal by any person.
- (2) Where a person makes a complaint under subsection (1), the complaint shall be by affidavit by himself setting out the allegations of professional misconduct which appear to arise on the complaint to the Tribunal, accompanied by such fee as may be prescribed by rules made under [section 58](#)(6); and every such fee shall be paid to the Society and may be applied by the Society to all or any of the objects of the Society.
- (3) Where a complaint is referred to the Tribunal under Part X or subsection (1) the Tribunal shall give the advocate against whom the complaint is made an opportunity to appear before it, and shall furnish him with a copy of the complaint, and of any evidence in support thereof, and shall give him an opportunity of inspecting any relevant document not less than seven days before the date fixed for the hearing:

Provided that, where in the opinion of the Tribunal the complaint does not disclose any *prima facie* case of professional misconduct, the Tribunal may, at any stage of the proceedings, dismiss such complaint without requiring the advocate to whom the complaint relates to answer any allegations made against him and without hearing the complaint.

- (4) After hearing the complaint and the advocate to whom the same relates, if he wishes to be heard, and considering the evidence adduced, the Tribunal may order that the complaint be dismissed or, if of the opinion that a case of professional misconduct on the part of the advocate has been made out, the Tribunal may order—
 - (a) that such advocate be admonished; or
 - (b) that such advocate be suspended from practice for a specified period not exceeding five years; or
 - (c) that the name of such advocate be struck off the Roll; or
 - (d) that such advocate do pay a fine not exceeding one million shillings; or

- (e) that such advocate pays to the aggrieved person compensation or reimbursement not exceeding five million shillings, or such combination of the above orders as the Tribunal thinks fit.
- (5) The Tribunal may make any such order as to payment by any party of any costs or witness expenses and of the expenses of the Tribunal or the members thereof in connection with the hearing of any complaint as it may think fit, and any such order may be registered with the Court and shall thereupon be enforceable in the same manner as an order of the Court to the like effect.
- (6) Where an advocate against whom the Tribunal is hearing a complaint relating to fees and costs has not filed a bill of costs in Court, the Tribunal may upon the request of the complainant, order such an advocate to produce before it a detailed fee note:

Provided that where the advocate fails to comply with an order of the Tribunal under this subsection, the Tribunal may determine the fee payable to the advocate in such sums as it deems fit.
- (7) If a bill of costs has been filed in Court by the advocate against whom a complaint is being heard but has not been taxed, the Tribunal may adjourn the complaint for such period as it considers reasonable to allow such taxation:

Provided that if at the expiry of such adjournment, the bill is still not taxed, the Tribunal may make its own estimate of the costs due to the advocate and make orders accordingly.
- (8) A determination of the Tribunal under subsections (7) and (8) shall be deemed, for all purposes, to be a determination of the Court.
- (9) In any case where the complainant has not filed a civil suit against the advocate in respect of the sum in dispute, the Tribunal may order the advocate to pay to the complainant such sum as it finds to be due from the advocate.
- (10) An order made by the Tribunal under this section—
 - (a) shall be in the name of the advocate or firm of advocates in respect of whom or which the order is made;
 - (b) may be filed in the civil registry of the Court by any party thereto who shall, within twenty-one days of the filing, give a notice to all other parties in writing of the filing of the order, which shall bear the date, the cause number and the registry in which it has been filed and a return of service of the order.
- (11) If no memorandum of appeal is filed in accordance with subsection (1) of [section 62](#) the party in favour of whom the order is made may apply ex parte by summons for leave to enforce such order as a decree, and the order may be executed in the same manner as an order of the Court to the like effect and, if it is an order for the recovery of money, may be enforced on the immovable and movable property of the advocate in accordance with the Civil Procedure Rules([Cap. 21](#), Sub. Leg.).
- (12) The Tribunal may issue a warrant for the levy of the amount of any sum ordered to be paid by virtue of this section on the immovable and movable property of the advocate by distress and sale under warrant, and such warrant shall be enforced as if it were a warrant issued by the Court.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

60A. Hearing of complaints

- (1) The powers conferred on the Committee by this section may be exercised on the hearing of—
 - (a) any application or complaint made to the Committee under this Act by or on behalf of the Council;
 - (b) any application made to the Committee by the Complaints Commission under this Act; or

- (c) any application or complaint made to the Committee under this Act, by or on behalf of any person.
- (2) Where, on the hearing of any application or complaint with respect to an advocate or firm of advocates, it appears to the Committee that the professional services provided by such advocate or firm in connection with any matter in which such advocate or firm of advocates had been instructed by a client were, in any respect, not of the quality that could reasonably have been expected of an advocate, then, subject to subsection (4), the Committee may, if it thinks fit, do one or more of the following things, namely—
 - (a) determine that the costs to which the advocate or firm of advocates shall be entitled, in respect of those services shall be limited to such amount as may be specified in its determination and by order, direct the advocate to comply, or to secure compliance, with such one or more requirements falling within subsection (3) as appear to it to be necessary in order to give effect to its determination; or
 - (b) by order direct the advocate or firm of advocates to secure the rectification at their own expense of any error, omission or other deficiency arising in connection with the matter as it may specify; or
 - (c) by order direct the advocate or firm of advocates to take at their own expense, such other action in the interests of the client as it may specify.
- (3) The requirements referred to in paragraph (a) of subsection (2) are—
 - (a) a requirement to refund the whole or part of any amount already paid by or on behalf of the client in respect of the advocate's costs in respect of services rendered in connection with the matter;
 - (b) a requirement to remit the whole or part of the costs; and
 - (c) a requirement to waive, whether wholly or to any specified extent, the right to recover those costs.
- (4) The Committee shall not exercise any of its powers under this section unless it is satisfied that it would in all circumstances, be appropriate to do so; and in determining whether in any case it would be appropriate to exercise any of those powers, the Committee may have regard—
 - (a) to the existence of any remedy that could reasonably be expected to be available to the client in civil proceeding; or
 - (b) where proceedings seeking any such remedy have not been commenced by the client, whether it would be reasonable to expect him to commence such proceedings.
- (5) Where the Committee has given a direction under subsection (2)(a) in order to give effect to a determination by it under that provision, then—
 - (a) for the purposes of any taxation of a bill covering those costs the amount charged by the bill in respect of those costs shall be deemed to be limited to the amount specified by the Committee; and
 - (b) where a bill covering those costs has not been taxed in accordance with paragraph (a), the client shall, for the purposes of the recovery of those costs (by whatever means) and notwithstanding any statutory provision or agreement, be deemed to be liable to pay costs only to the extent of the amount specified by the Committee.
- (6) Where a bill covering those costs has been taxed in accordance with subsection (5)(a), the Committee's direction under subsection (2)(a) shall, so far as relating to those costs, cease to have effect.

- (7) For the purposes of this section, "client", in relation to any matter in which an advocate or firm of advocates has been instructed, includes any person on whose behalf the person who gave the instructions was acting.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

61. Reports by Tribunal and action thereon

- (1) On the termination of the hearing of a complaint, if the Tribunal does not dismiss the same, the Tribunal shall embody its findings and the order or orders made by it in the form of a report to the Court, which shall be delivered to the Registrar, together with the record of evidence taken and any documents put in evidence.
- (2) The Registrar shall give to the complainant, to the Complaints Commission (if the complainant has been referred by it to the Tribunal), to the Council of the Society and to the advocate to whom the complaint relates notice of delivery of the report, which shall be open to inspection by the complainant, the Commissioner, the advocate to whom the complaint relates and their respective advocates, if any, and by the Council.
- (3) At the conclusion of the hearing of a complaint the Tribunal may, if evidence of an offence appears to it to have been disclosed under [section 80](#), make a report of the proceedings and its findings to the Attorney-General who shall consider whether to exercise his powers under that section.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

62. Appeal against order of Tribunal

- (1) Any advocate aggrieved by order of the Tribunal made under [section 60](#) may, within fourteen days after the receipt by him of the notice to be given to him pursuant to [section 61\(2\)](#), appeal against such order to the Court by giving notice of appeal to the Registrar, and shall file with the Registrar a memorandum setting out his grounds of appeal within thirty days after giving by him of such notice of appeal.
- (2) The Court shall set down for hearing any appeal filed under subsection (1) and shall give to the Council of the Society and to the advocate not less than twenty-one days' notice of the date of hearing.
- (3) An appeal under this section shall not suspend the effect or stay the execution of the order appealed against notwithstanding that the order is not a final order.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

63. Registrar to furnish copy of the report and record

When notifying the Council of the Society and the advocate to whom a complaint relates of the date fixed for the hearing of the appeal, the Registrar shall also forward to the Council and the advocate a copy of the report of the evidence, a list of any documents put in evidence and the memorandum of appeal.

64. Powers of Court

The Court, after considering the evidence taken by the Tribunal, the report of the Tribunal and the memorandum of appeal, and having heard the parties, and after taking any further evidence, if it thinks fit so to do, may—

- (a) refer the report back to the Tribunal with directions for its findings on any specified point; or

- (b) confirm, set aside or vary any order made by the Tribunal or substitute therefor such order as it may think fit;

and may also make such order as to the payment by any person of costs, or otherwise in relation to the appeal, as it may think fit.

[Act No. 12 of 2012, Sch.]

65. Powers of Court under [section 64](#) to be exercised by two judges

- (1) The powers conferred upon the Court by [section 64](#) shall be exercised by not less than two of the judges of the Court.
- (2) If such powers are exercised by two judges and the opinion of the Court is equally divided, the matter shall be reheard by three judges.
- (3) If such powers are exercised by three judges and they do not agree in their opinion, the decision of the majority shall be taken to be the decision of the Court.

66. Registrar to draw up orders

Where an order has been made by the Court under [section 64](#), the Registrar shall, within one week from the date of the making thereof, cause the order to be drawn up.

67. Right of appeal to Court of Appeal

- (1) Any advocate aggrieved by a decision or order of the Court made under [section 64](#) may appeal therefrom to the Court of Appeal in the manner and within the time prescribed by the rules made from time to time by the Court relating to second appeals in civil matters.
- (2) An appeal under this section shall not suspend the effect or stay the execution of the decision or order appealed against notwithstanding that the order concerned is not a final order.

68. Orders to be noted on the Roll

- (1) The Registrar shall cause a note of the effect of a final order to be entered in the Roll against the name of the advocate concerned, and where the order so directs shall remove or strike off his name from the Roll.
- (2) The Registrar shall send to the secretary of the Society a certified copy of every final order made under this Part removing or striking off the name of an advocate from the Roll or suspending an advocate from practice.
- (3) Where an advocate is a member of a professional body outside Kenya, or is subject to the jurisdiction for the purposes of discipline of a professional body outside Kenya, the Registrar shall also send to the professional body a certified copy of every final order made under this Part suspending or striking off the name of the advocate from the Roll.

69. Law Society to be informed of result of disciplinary proceedings and publicity of striking-off or suspension

- (1) The Registrar shall inform the secretary to the Society of the making of an entry in respect of any advocate on the Roll and of the removal from, or the striking off, the Roll of the name of any advocate in accordance with the provisions of this Part.
- (2) The Registrar shall cause to be published in the *Gazette* a notice that a final order has been made in respect of any advocate whereby he has been suspended from practice or whereby his name has

been struck off the Roll and the Society may publish a similar notice in at least one daily newspaper of national circulation.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

70. Limitation of time for certain applications to strike names off the Roll

Subject as hereinafter provided, no advocate shall be liable to have his name struck off the Roll on account of any defect in his admission and enrolment, unless the application to strike his name off the Roll is made within twelve months after the date of his enrolment:

Provided that this section shall not apply to any case where fraud is proved to have been committed in connection with the admission or enrolment.

71. Restoration to Roll

The Chief Justice shall, upon the recommendation of the Tribunal and with the written approval of the Chairman of the Society, order the Registrar to restore on the Roll the name of any advocate whose name has been removed or struck off the Roll, and the Registrar shall, upon payment by the advocate of the prescribed fee, restore such name accordingly.

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

72. Disciplinary powers as to clerks

- (1) An application may be made by or on behalf of the Council of the Society to the Tribunal for an order directing that, as from a date to be specified in such order, no advocate shall, in connection with his practise as an advocate, without the written permission of such Council, which may be given for such period and subject to such conditions as such Council may think fit, take into or retain in his employment or remunerate any person, who, being or having been a clerk to an advocate—
 - (a) has been convicted of any offence mentioned in Chapters XI, XXVI, XXXII or XXXV, in or against any one or more of sections 280, 281, 282, 285, 293, 294, 308, 311, 314, or 393 of the Penal Code ([Cap. 63](#)), or any offence mentioned in the Prevention of Corruption Act (Cap. 65); or
 - (b) has been convicted of any offence involving fraud or deceit; or
 - (c) has been party to any act or default of an advocate in respect of which a complaint has been or might be made against such advocate to the Tribunal; or
 - (d) has so conducted himself whilst employed as a clerk to an advocate that, had he himself been an advocate, such conduct might have formed the subject of a complaint against him to the Tribunal.
- (2) The provisions of [section 58](#) and of subsections (4), (5) and (6) of [section 60](#) shall apply, mutatis mutandis, to the hearing of an application under this section.
- (3) Every order made by the Tribunal under this section shall be filed, on a file to be kept for that purpose, by the secretary to the Tribunal who shall cause a certified copy of such order to be delivered to the person to whom it relates or shall forward the same by registered post to his last known address.
- (4) The file mentioned in subsection (3) may be inspected by any advocate during office hours without payment.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

73. Clerk's right of appeal

- (1) Any person against whom an order has been made by the Tribunal under [section 72](#) may, within fourteen days of the date of such order, appeal against such order to the Court, by giving notice of appeal to the Registrar and shall file with the Registrar a memorandum setting out his grounds of appeal within thirty days after the giving by him of such notice of appeal.
- (2) The Court shall set down for hearing any appeal filed under subsection (1) and shall give to the Council of the Society and to the appellant not less than twenty-one days' notice of the hearing.
- (3) The provisions of sections [64](#), [65](#) and [79](#) shall apply, *mutatis mutandis* to the hearing of an appeal under this section.
- (4) The decision of the Court shall be final.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

74. Offences and penalties with respect to employment of clerks against whom an order is in force

- (1) Any person against whom an order made under [section 72](#) is in force who seeks or accepts employment by, or remuneration from, an advocate in connection with his practice as an advocate without previously informing him of the order shall be guilty of an offence.
- (2) Any advocate who knowingly acts in contravention of an order made under [section 72](#) or in contravention of any condition subject to which the permission of the Council of the Society may have been given under subsection (1) of that section shall be guilty of an offence.

75. Order of Tribunal to be received in evidence

Every report and every order made by the Tribunal under this Part shall be signed by the chairman of the Tribunal, and any document, purporting to be a report or an order so signed shall be received in evidence in any judicial proceedings or in any proceedings under this Act, and shall be deemed to be such a report or an order without further proof of its contents unless the contrary is shown.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

76. Authentication of rules and other documents

Subject to [section 75](#), all rules, certificates, notices and other documents made or issued by the Tribunal for any purpose whatsoever may be signed on behalf of the Tribunal by the secretary to the Tribunal or by such member or other person as the Tribunal may for that purpose appoint.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

77. Penalties for failure to comply with order of Tribunal

Any person who, without good and lawful excuse, contravenes or fails to comply with any order, notice or direction of the Tribunal or the Complaints Commission shall be guilty of an offence and, in the case of an advocate, shall, alternatively or in addition, be liable to proceedings under [section 60](#).

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

78. Immunity for members of Tribunal

No member of the Tribunal, nor any person who is or was at any material time a member, or the secretary, thereof, shall be liable to be sued in any civil court for or in respect of any act or thing done or omitted to be done, or ordered to be done or omitted, by him, in good faith, in the exercise, discharge or performance

or intended or purported exercise, discharge or performance, of any of the powers jurisdiction, duties or functions conferred upon him under or by virtue of this Act.

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

79. Right to legal representation

Any advocate against whom a complaint is made or any complainant under Part X or this Part, may be represented by an advocate.

80. Betrayal of trust

Any person who, being an advocate, is entrusted in his professional capacity with any money, valuable security or other property to retain it in safe custody with instructions to pay or apply it for any purpose in connection with his duty as an advocate fails to pay, apply or account for the same after due completion of the purpose for which it was given, shall be guilty of an offence:

Provided that no prosecution for an offence under this section shall be instituted unless a report has been made to the Attorney-General by the Tribunal under subsection (3) of [section 61](#).

[Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch.]

Part XII – MISCELLANEOUS PROVISIONS

81. Power to make rules

- (1) The Council of the Society, with the approval of the Chief Justice, may make rules with regard to—
 - (a) the professional practice, conduct and discipline of advocates;
 - (aa) the admission of advocates under section 15;
 - (b) the keeping of accounts by advocates;
 - (c) the annual submission to the Council of a certificate by an accountant registered under the Accountants Act ([Cap. 531](#)) or by some other person or class of persons specified by such Council that he has examined the books, accounts and documents of the advocate to such extent as may be prescribed and stating—
 - (i) whether or not he is satisfied that, during the period covered by his certificate, the advocate has complied with the rules for the time being in force regulating the keeping of accounts by advocates; and
 - (ii) if he is not so satisfied, the matters in respect of which he is not satisfied;
 - (d) the retention or otherwise by advocates of interest earned on moneys deposited, received or held for or on account of clients;
 - (e) the issue of practising certificates, the fee payable thereon and the duties of the Registrar with respect to the issuing of such certificates;
 - (ee) the procedure for the conferment of, and the privileges attached to, the rank of Senior Counsel;
 - (f) the establishment of a compensation fund for the benefit of clients;
 - (g) indemnity for clients against loss or damage arising from claims in respect of any civil liability incurred by an advocate or his employee, or from breach of trust by the advocate or his employee;
 - (h) continuing professional education for all advocates practising in Kenya;

- (i) generally for the better carrying out of the provisions of this Act, other than Parts III, IV, IX, X and XI.
- (2) If an advocate fails to comply with any rules made under this section, any person may make a complaint in respect of that failure to the Disciplinary Tribunal.
- (3) No rule made under this section shall require an advocate who is a member of the National Assembly or the Speaker and who holds a practising certificate to undergo continuing legal education during his tenure as such member or as the Speaker.

[Act [No. 7 of 1990](#), Act [No. 9 of 2000](#), s. 63, Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch., Act [No. 7 of 2007](#), Sch., Act [No. 6 of 2009](#), Sch., Act [No. 12 of 2012](#), Sch, Act [No. 3 of 2024](#), Sch.]

82. Relief to banks

- (1) Subject to this section, no bank shall, in connection with any transaction on any amount of any advocate kept with it or with any other bank (other than an account kept by an advocate as trustee for a specified beneficiary) incur any liability or be under any obligation to make an inquiry, or be deemed to have any knowledge of any right of any person to any money paid or credited to any such account which it would not incur or be under or be deemed to have in the case of an account kept by a person entitled absolutely to all the money paid or credited to it:

Provided that nothing in this subsection shall relieve a bank from any liability or obligation to which it would be subject apart from this Act.

- (2) Notwithstanding anything in subsection (1), a bank at which an advocate keeps an account for client's money shall not, in respect of any liability of the advocate to the bank, not being a liability in connection with that account, have or obtain any recourse or right, whether by way of set-off, counterclaim, charge or otherwise, against moneys standing to the credit of that account.

83. Saving of other laws

Nothing in this Act or any rules made thereunder shall affect the provisions of any other written law empowering any unqualified person to conduct, defend or otherwise act in relation to any legal proceedings.

84. Application of certain fees, etc.

All admission fees received by the Registrar under section [11\(2\)](#) or [15\(4\)](#), and all fees received by the Registrar in respect of replacing an advocate's name on the Roll under [section 71](#), shall be paid by the Registrar to the Society, and those fees together with the fees for practising certificates and the Society's annual subscriptions, both of which shall be collected by the Society, shall be applied by the Society to all or any of the objects of the Society.

85. General penalty

- (1) Any person who is guilty of an offence under this Act for which no penalty is otherwise provided shall be liable to a fine not exceeding one hundred thousand shillings or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding two years or both.
- (2) Any advocate who is guilty of an offence under this Act shall be liable, whether or not he has been charged with, convicted or acquitted of such offence, to proceedings under [section 60](#).

[Act [No. 2 of 2002](#), Sch.]

86. Repeal and savings

- (1) The Advocates Act, 1949 is repealed.

- (2) Without prejudice to the generality of the application of subsection (3) of section 23 of the Interpretation and General Provisions Act ([Cap. 2](#)), the transitional provisions set out in the Second Schedule to this Act shall have effect on the repeal of the Advocates Act ([Cap. 16](#)).

FIRST SCHEDULE [s. 3]

REPEALED

Repealed by Act [No. 12 of 1995](#), s. 21.

SECOND SCHEDULE [s. 86]

TRANSITIONAL PROVISIONS

1. The four advocates who, immediately before the commencement of this Act, were members of the Council of Legal Education then existing shall be deemed to be the four advocates nominated by the Society for the purposes of [section 3](#) of this Act.
2. The Roll of all advocates kept by the Registrar in accordance with the provisions of [section 20](#) the Advocates Act ([Cap. 16](#)) (hereinafter referred to as "the repealed Act") shall continue to be the Roll of Advocates for the purposes of this Act.
3. Any practising certificate issued by the Registrar in accordance with the provisions of the repealed Act and in force at the commencement of this Act shall be deemed to have been issued in accordance with the provisions of this Act.
4. The Disciplinary Committee established by the repealed Act shall become and shall be the Disciplinary Committee for the purposes of this Act and any complaint or matter pending before the Disciplinary Committee at the commencement of this Act shall continue before the Disciplinary Committee in accordance with the provisions of the repealed Act, as the case may require.
5. Notwithstanding the repeal of the Advocates Act, a person who, immediately before the commencement of this Act, was serving articles of clerkship registered under section 14 of the Act shall continue to serve under those articles until the date of expiry and shall be deemed to be duly qualified for the purposes of section 12 of this Act.
6. Notwithstanding the repeal of the Advocates Act, a person who, immediately before the commencement of this Act, was undergoing instruction as a pupil in accordance with section 12 or 18A thereof, shall continue to receive instruction as a pupil for the prescribed period until the date of expiry and shall be deemed to have duly complied with subparagraph (i) of subsection (1) of [section 13](#) of this Act.